

it be – Microsoft has long featured a great deal of functionality for office use. With Windows 8, new features have come in and the old ones are more advanced. While an average user would only imagine that the business use is limited to things such as a shared printer, shared network connection and remote desktop, there's a whole lot more required of an enterprise office PC.

The enterprise landscape needs higher level features than a PC. The Enterprise edition comes with features which not only help manage the office environment in a friendlier, yet sophisticated manner but also



Windows 8 has a separate edition for Enterprise use

provide a higher level of security. Feature-wise, Windows 8 Enterprise is the best you can get. However, it is actually volume licensed and you can't get a retail package – you can only order it in volumes.

While some enterprise level features are available in Windows 8 Pro as well, features such as AppLocker, DirectAccess, Windows To Go, Branch Cache and NFS

(Network File System) Services are exclusive to Windows 8 Enterprise edition. Let's talk about the features available in Windows 8 Pro as well as Windows 8 Enterprise.

Booting from VHD

If you've ever paid any attention to virtualization technologies, virtual hard disks (VHD) would ring a bell. It's the disk image file format for Microsoft Virtual PC as well as for Hyper-V on server platforms. VHD booting was added to Windows' capability list in Windows 7. Windows 8 Pro and above can use the technology.

The advantages of booting from VHD are numerous. You could use it as an alternate installation in case the primary Windows installation doesn't work. You can use it as a secondary installation on a USB drive with all programs loaded – a kind of "PC in the Pocket" scenario. Alternatively, you could even virtualize the same into a Microsoft Virtual PC or Hyper-V setup. Even VirtualBox supports this format so you are not out of luck if you run Mac or Linux. Since VHD installations can run directly on the